STRATEGIC PLANNING

St. Thomas University – Global American American Learning

Reference plan for the operational launch of St. Thomas Global American Learning University (STU). Starting from:

- a comparative analysis of the top American online universities;
- the identification of the AI-Native University model;
- the current capabilities of STU.

6
ANALYSIS SECTIONS

16
DETAIL SLIDE

Sept. 2026
LAUNCH TARGET

Vision

Confidential

Establishing the first 'transatlantic-native' university creates a unique competitive advantage in the global higher education market.

Ecosystem

Creation of the first university ecosystem with International reach.
Strategic integration between consolidated assets in Italy (e-Campus/Link, etc.) and the new Hub USA (St. Thomas Charlotte).

One Degree, Two Continents

The only operator capable of offering an American degree with European validation. Bridges the market gap for students seeking global mobility without prohibitive costs.

Objective 2029

Reach 50,000 "hybrid" students by 2029 with a scalable business model that generates interesting EBITDA.

INTERNATIONAL STRATEGY: DUAL DEGREE AND MARKETS AFRICA/MENA

STU positions itself as an international university with two growth vectors: agreements in Africa/MENA (100-300 students per students per intake) and dual degree with an Italian university as the most solid path for European recognition.

VECTOR 1 — EXPANSION AFRICA / MENA

100–300

STUDENTS PER INTAKE PER AGREEMENT

Agreements with universities and local institutions already in progress.definition (e.g. China)

Active

AGREEMENTS WITH MENA/AFRICA INSTITUTIONS

Potential pool: Sub-Saharan Africa, North Africa, Middle East

USA + EU

VALUE OF THE DEGREE FOR MENA STUDENTS

Dual usability of the degree: US market and European market through an agreement with an Italian university university

SYNERGY WITH MEDEA PROJECT (MULTIVERSITY)

The MEDEA project of Multiversity (Malta) targets the same MENA/Africa markets. STU provides the USA component of the title, creating a unique "Three Continents" offering in the international landscape.

VECTOR 2 — EUROPEAN RECOGNITION: THREE PATHWAYS IN COMPARISON

PATHWAY	DESCRIPTION	ADVANTAGES	CRITICAL ISSUES
A — Dual Degree (RECOMMENDED)	Formal agreement with a recognized Italian university university MUR (e.g., iCampus/Link Campus). The The student obtains STU + Italian degree. Historical examples already realized.	**A more solid path. path. Immediate legal value in the EU. Independent of of the USA process. process.**	Requires formal agreement with partner university. university. Curricular coordination.
B — Filiation in Italy	Opening of an operational branch of STU in Italy. Under Under evaluation. Requires MUR authorization to operate operate in Italian territory.	**Physical presence in Italy. Direct brand in the market.**	MUR process lengthy and complex. High fixed operational operational costs. costs.
C — Formal Recognition MUR	Direct recognition pathway of the STU title by the Italian Ministry of University and Research. To be discussed with ownership.	**Full and direct recognition of the degree in Italy.**	Very long timelines. It depends on bilateral agreements between the USA and Italy.

SECTION 1

The Online Market in the USA: Who Dominates and with What Model

The online education market in the USA exceeds **$100 billion** with over **8 million students** enrolled in fully-online programs. The concentration is high: the top 5 players control over 40% of online enrollments.

UNIVERSITY	STUDENTS	ACCRED.	MODEL	STRENGTH
WGU	~180k	NWCCU	Competency-Based (CBE)	ROI 36x, flat-rate $8.3k/year
SNHU	~300k	NECHE	Master Course + Marketing	650 courses/year, industrial scale
ASU Online	~60k	HLC	EdPlus 7-phase + AI authoring	300+ programs, R1 brand
Penn State WC	~17k	MSCHE	Research University + Online	Reputation R1, employer trust
FIU Online	~20k	SACSCOC	Quality Matters certified	Business/Health, Latino market
STU Charlotte	<100	Only NC	Pre-Online (under construction)	Active license, governance in place

Source: IPEDS 2024-25, WGU FY2025 Annual Report, Washington Post 2026, internal processing.

KEY SCALE FACTOR

accreditation **regional** (HLC, SACSCOC, NECHE) is the non-negotiable prerequisite: enables the **Title IV Federal Aid**, which accounts for 60-70% of the revenues of leading online universities.

THE SCALE PARADOX

WGU and SNHU have demonstrated that **quality and volume are not mutually exclusive**: with the Master Course Model and CBE, both maintain satisfaction rates > 95% among hundreds of thousands of students.

SECTION 1

The 10 Ingredients of Success: The Genetic Code of Top Online Universities

01

Regional Accreditation

Prerequisite for Title IV Federal Aid.
Without it, no scale is possible in the US market.

02

CBE Model or Master Course

A high-quality "master" course cloned for thousands of students ensures quality and scale scale without degradation.

03

Advanced LMS + xAPI

LMS with Knowledge Layer and AI.
The platform is the "product."
Advanced services and predictive analytics for analytics for customized solutions.

04

Aggressive Digital Marketing

Google, Meta, LinkedIn + strong brand.
SNHU spends $200M+/year.
Marketing is the engine of growth.

05

Student Success Services

Dedicated advisors, tutoring career services.
Retention is the true economic KPI: each lost student is worth $8k+.

06

Competitive Pricing

Flat-rate (WGU $8.3k/year) or per-credit ($342 ($342 SNHU). Accessibility is a lever for acquisition acquisition.

07

Employer Partnerships

WGU: 90% employer satisfaction.
Partnerships validate competencies and drive drive placement.

08

Structured Faculty Model

Faculty of Record (accountability) + Adjuncts (delivery) + AI (scale). Clear separation of roles roles.

09

Compliance Layer

FERPA, Title IV, accreditation standards. A dedicated Chief Compliance Officer is non-negotiable.

10

AI-Native Evolution

Adaptive tutoring AI-assisted authoring predictive predictive analytics. IU: -27% perceived study time. study time.

Insight:

- Ingredients 01-05 (dark background) are **structural prerequisites** without which growth is not possible/sustainable.
- The ingredients 06-10 are **performance multipliers** that amplify the competitive advantage once the foundation is solid.

St. Thomas University must first build a solid foundation (01-05), and then accelerate by implementing the other ingredients (06-10).

THE ARCHITECTURAL BLUEPRINT

A global university requires a layered architecture that integrates engagement, academic core, business core, business support, and data foundation.

★ Components Necessary Phase 1

LAYER 1: ENGAGEMENT (STUDENT & STAFF FACING)

- CRM ★
- Student Portal ★
- Mobile App
- Marketing Mautic
- Service Cloud
- AI Chatbot

LAYER 2: CORE ACADEMIC SYSTEMS

- SIS & AUTHORING ★
- LMS ★
- Knowledge Student System
- Proctoring
- Library System
- Academic Advising

LAYER 3: AI, BUSINESS SUPPORT & OPERATIONS

- ERP Finance ★
- HCM
- Facility Mgmt
- Procurement
- Compliance Engine
- Tax Management
- RAG Management ★
- Recommendation & Adaptive Learning

LAYER 4: DATA FOUNDATION, INTEGRATION & ORCHESTRATION

- iPaaS () ★
- Data Lake
- BI Platform
- API Gateway ★
- AI/ML Engine ★
- Data Management ★
- Identity & Access Srv ★ Srv
- FAST API microSrv ★

ARCHITECTURAL REQUIREMENTS

Multi-Site

Integrated Facility Management with academic scheduling. Management of distributed campuses with centralized visibility.

Multi-Brand

Separate front-ends for each brand (e-Campus, Link, St. Link, St. Thomas). Consolidated back-end for finance and finance and operations.

Multi-Nation

GDPR (EU) and FERPA (USA) compliance. Multi-currency currency and multi-GAAP management. Data sovereignty sovereignty by region.

Event-Driven

Event-driven architecture for real-time sync. Reduces Reduces latency and enables intelligent automation. automation.

Three structural challenges make the production of academic content slow and non-scalable.

The traditional production of academic content is fragmented, untraceable, and reliant on manual processes that do not scale with the growth of with the growth of the educational offerings.

1. Fragmentation of roles

Dean, Faculty, and staff operate in in silos without a shared model of of integrated data and workflows. workflows.

2. Absence of metadata

Content is produced without a control control layer that enables governance, governance, research, and customization.

3. Unregulated generation

The use of generative AI without quality gates produces untraceable and academically unapproved content.

4. Limited scalability

The manual review of each asset cannot withstand the exponential increase in the educational catalog.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

An architecture is needed that treats metadata as the primary control surface and maintains governance in the hands of academics, with AI as an accelerator — not as a substitute.

The model STU (proposed) defines three roles with distinct and non-overlapping responsibilities

The clear separation between roles strategic (Provost/Dean), teaching role (Faculty) and AI system at support, provides human governance and traceability.

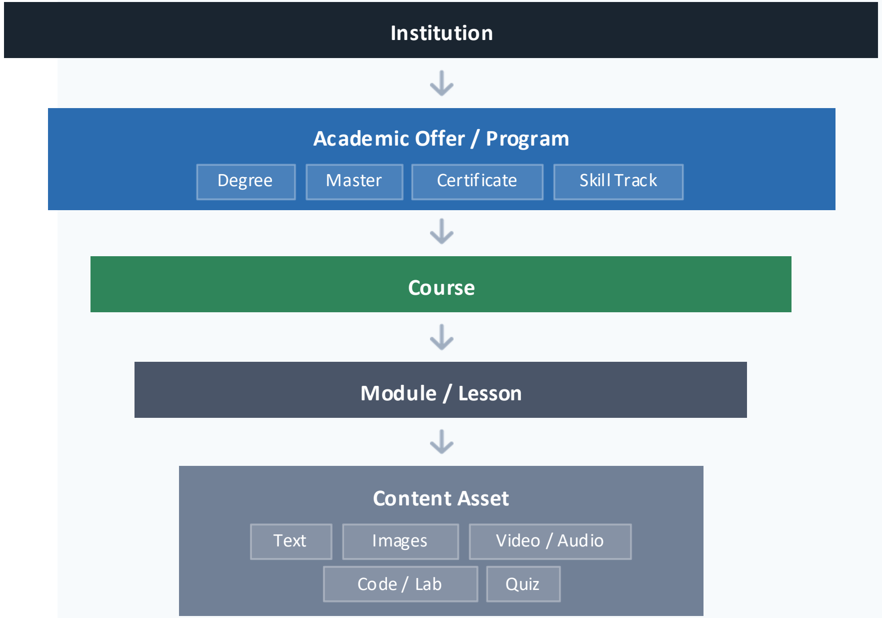
Role	Perimeter	Key Responsibilities
Provost/Dean / Academic Admin	Strategic	Defines the educational offer, approves the initial catalog, reviews and approves the final course for publication.
Faculty / Instructor	Didactic-Operational	Design the modules, upload the reference sources, defines The metadata, launchesthe AI generation, reviews the outputs and approves the Course version andofModules.
AI System (Orchestrator)	Generative	Generate assets based on blueprints, propagate metadata, perform automatic quality checks, and assemble the context package.
Student / Learner	Utilization	Interacts with content; its signals and performance drive runtime personalization.

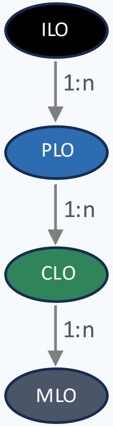
GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLE

Every critical approval remains human.
Technology can assists the creative process and accelerates production, but it never decides on the academic validity of content.

The information model is hierarchical, traceable, and has metadata inheritance

The entire academic structure — from the program to the individual asset — is modeled as a hierarchy with controlled propagation of metadata, ensuring consistency and the possibility of local override.





HERITAGE RULE

Metadata flows from top to bottom with the possibility of **local override**.

- **Language:** default inherited from the program, but overridable at the individual module level.
- **Accessibility:** requirements inherited from the institution and applied strictly at the asset level.
- **Competencies:** taxonomy inherited from the course and refined into specific objectives in the module.

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CORSO
└─ MODULO (Section)  ← unità tematica principale
    └─ PAGINA (Page) ← unità di fruizione
        └─ COMPONENTE (Component) ← mattone atomico del contenuto
```

The process is divided into three sequential phases with quality gates.explicit at each transition

The workflow imposes that every published content has crossed : validation of the blueprint, content generation, review Faculty and approval Dean — with a complete record of every decision.

PHASE A
DEFINITION OF CATALOG

- Dean creates Academic Offer
- Defines Program metadata
- Approve baseline course catalog

PHASE B
DESIGN & GENERATION

- Faculty designs module blueprint
- Launch AI job generation
- Review and approve module

PHASE C
REVIEW & PUBLICATION

- Dean reviews complete course
- Verify consistency and compliance
- Approves and publishes

GATE 1 — BLUEPRINT VALIDATION (Dean & Provost)

The module must have MLO, media mix, sources, and assessment strategy before the generation starts.

GATE 2 — FACULTY REVIEW (Faculty)

Verification of factual correctness, pedagogical coherence, linguistic quality, and media appropriateness.

GATE 3 — FINAL APPROVAL (Dean & Provost)

Cross-academic coherence check, completeness of the course package, and institutional compliance.